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THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

MEMORANDUM OF TELEPHONE CONVERSATION

SUBJECT: Telephone conversation with President Carlos Andres Perez of Venezuela (U)

PARTICIPANTS: The President
Carlos Andres Perez of Venezuela
Interpreter: P
Notetaker: Dr

DATE, TIME February 8,
AND PLACE: Oval Office

*Call
made
from
Camp David*

The President telephoned President Perez and reported on the situation in

The President: Hello?

President Perez: Hello, Mr.

The President: Nice to hear your

President Perez: Thanks very much, Mr. I've been thinking of you a lot, and know of the decisions you are making. (U)

The President: I appreciate that. I'm really calling, with no special agenda, but since I haven't talked with you for a while, I wanted to give you a progress report on the situation in the Gulf. Let me go through a few points, and then I will answer your questions. (U)

In the first place, I want to say that we are not targeting civilians or holy sites. I think people who look at targeting and see the pictures are convinced that we have done a good job, that we've been very precise. (U)

As you probably know, I've sent Dick Cheney and Powell to the theater. They will report back on Monday. (U)

No decision has been made yet on a ground campaign. I am somewhat skeptical that air power alone can drive Iraq out of Kuwait, but I really want to hear from Cheney and Powell. (U)

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